Khondoker Ittehadul Islam

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Education

University of Groningen, Saarland University — *Groningen & Saarbrücken*

Double Degree Master's In LCT — *2024 - 2026 (Sept. expected)*

- CGPA in *German*: $1.7/4.0$
- Thesis: Analyzing Internal Geometry of Adaptation Methods. (*Proposal*:)

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology — *Sylhet, Bangladesh*

B.Sc. in Computer Science — *2017 - 2021*

- CGPA: $3.35/4.00$
- Thesis: Robustness Evaluation of Language Models on Low-Resource Language.

Skills

`Programming & Tools`	Python, Git, Docker, Slurm, Bash, Weights & Biases, LaTeX
`LLM & ML Frameworks`	PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, vLLM, LogitLens, NumPy, Pandas
`Research Interest`	Interpretability, Architecture Design & Evaluation, Computational Biology

Publications

- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, *Gabriele Sarti*; Reveal-Bangla: A Dataset for Cross-Lingual Multi-Step Reasoning Evaluation. **BLP workshop @ IJCNLP-AACL 2025**.
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, *Tanvir Hossain Yuvraz, Md Saiful Islam, Enamul Hassan*; EmoNoBa: A Dataset for Analyzing Fine-Grained Emotions on Noisy Bangla Texts. **AACL-IJCNLP 2022 Main**.
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, *Sudipta Kar, Md Saiful Islam, Mohammad Ruhul Amin*; SentNoB: A Dataset for Analysing Sentiment on Noisy Bangla Texts. **EMNLP 2021 Findings**.
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, *Md Saiful Islam, and Md Ruhul Amin*; Sentiment analysis in Bengali via transfer learning using multi-lingual BERT. **ICCIT 2020**.

Professional Experience

2026 - now **Student Research Assistant**, MLT-Lab, DFKI

- Built a holistic safety-evaluation pipeline for foundation models across multiple modalities.
- Designed reproducible LLM-as-a-Judge, robustness, and prompt-injection benchmarks.

2024 - 2025 **Student Research Intern**, InCLow Lab, University of Groningen

- Analyzed LLM reasoning across languages, variants, and parameter scales.
- Utilized NLI, RAG, and attribution techniques (ContextCite) in a cross-lingual evaluation.
- Reported fixed reasoning pattern shared across languages regardless of resource level.
- Publications: *BLP workshop @ IJCNLP-AACL 2025* .

2021 - 2024 **Software Engineer**, REVE Systems

- Digitalized the administrative workflow process of a Transport Organization.
- Incorporated Theory-of-Computation (ToC) concepts to automate the chain-of-decisions.
- Production: https://smart.dgt.gov.bd/login

Selected Research Projects

Tackling OOV: Masked Language Models vs Character Diffusion — *2026*

Saarland University — *Saarbrücken, Germany*

- Trained NanoGPT and Character Diffusion on reddit corpus.
- Reported higher Character Diffusion performance on the OLID task.
- *Repo*: https://github.com/KhondokerIslam/mlm-vs-dlm-on-oov

Evaluating Protein Language Models in Long Protein Sequence Generation — *2026*

Saarland University — *Saarbrücken, Germany*

- Evaluated state-of-the-art PLM on >1k long-sequence generation tasks.
- Observed random baselines to perform better.
- *Repo*: https://github.com/KhondokerIslam/ml4lp

OCR on Historical Documents *2025*

University of Groningen *Groningen, Netherlands*

- Improved linguistic capabilities of vLMs for OCR tasks.
- Composited image to augment ancient documents.
- Heuristically pseudo-labeled multi-class unlabeled documents.
- Report: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2508.10356

Attributing LLM CoT Reasoning Answers *2025*

University of Groningen *Groningen, Netherlands*

- Applied ContextCite & Inseq to analyze CoT in Qwen2.5.
- Negation/distractors cut coherence & accuracy.
- Received *Best NLP Student Project Award*.
- Report: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2511.15886

Offensive Text Classification Leveraging Sentiment *2024*

University of Groningen *Groningen, Netherlands*

- Collected sentiment for each OLID instances using DeBERTa V3.
- Observed no positive-sentiment effect on offensive classification.
- Report: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2412.17825

Bachelor Thesis: LM Robustness Evaluation *2020-2022*

Shahjalal University of Science & Technology *Sylhet, Bangladesh*

- Proposed annotation metric for diverse, multi-label corpus for downstream tasks.
- Showed Transformers underperform vs. rule-based on morphologically-rich instances.
- Publications: *EMNLP 2021 Findings*, *AACL-IJCNLP 2022 Main*, *ICCIT 2020*

Awards

2025 **Best NLP Student Project Award**, @GroNLP, University of Groningen
Competed with 6 other student teams to produce impactful research.

2025 **Google & Zendesk Scholarship**, LxMLS 2025
Received expenses to participate in Lisbon ML Summer School.

2024 **NL Scholarship**, Nuffic, Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture, and Science
Awarded stipendium to support my academic endeavors.

2023 **Outstanding Reviewer**, BLP Workshop @ EMNLP 2023
Assisted program chairs and authors through constructive feedback.

2021 **Student Travel Scholarship**, EMNLP 2021
Awarded financial coverage to present my proceedings paper.

Academia Services

2024-2025 **Programme Committee Member**, ReMa Linguistics, CLCG, University of Groningen
Represented student cohort and provided course structural insights to the Dutch Education Ministry.